PAN SHORTBREAD

YIELD	OVEN	ENERGY COST
16 pieces	**325F, 35-40 min**	**$2.41 (40 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)**

INGREDIENTS

227 g	Salted butter, cool room temperature
113 g	Powdered sugar
10 ml	Vanilla extract
1.25 ml	Almond extract, optional, or another flavouring
1 g	Table salt
240 g	All-purpose flour
128 g	Garnish — semisweet or bittersweet chocolate, chopped (optional)
quantity not given	Garnish — chopped nuts or flaky sea salt, for sprinkling

METHOD

1. Beat the butter, sugar, the extracts and salt together.
2. Beat in the flour. It looks dry at first, so keep going until a stiff dough forms. Up to a tablespoon of water will bring it together if needed.
3. Press into a greased and parchment-lined 9 inch round or 8 inch square pan, smoothing the top.
4. Dock all over with a fork so steam escapes and it does not bubble.
5. Bake at 325F for 35 to 40 minutes, light golden on top and deeper at the edges.
6. Cool in the pan 5 to 10 minutes, cut while still slightly warm, then cool on a rack.
7. To garnish, melt the chocolate slowly so it does not seize.
8. Dip half of each piece, scatter nuts or flaky salt over the wet chocolate, and leave it to set.

NOTES

Pressed into a pan, so no rolling, cutting or chilling. The simplest route to shortbread here.
Salted butter plus added salt is deliberate. With unsalted, raise salt to about 1/2 tsp.
Flavour improves with age.
Takes additions well: crystallized ginger worked into the dough.
Keeps a week wrapped, freezes longer.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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